

Military Starships Reference

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Military Starships Reference - r4

Introduction

This supplement explores a selection of military ship models of varying classes. Like its sister supplement, the *Civilian Starships Reference*, it will be revised and expanded and is intended to be both remixed and personalized.

Aether Galaxy Starship Codes

Starship codes follow the format:

[Prefix][Size][Role]-[Hyperdrive Grade]

Where each component has the following meaning:

Prefix

Indicates vessel ownership or classification domain.

- **(none)** — Civilian vessel
 - **W** — Warship (military naval vessel)
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Size Codes

Indicate the displacement class.

- **L** — Light
 - **M** — Medium
 - **H** — Heavy
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Civilian Roles

Primary function of civilian vessels.

- **C** — Courier (speed-priority delivery)
 - **T** — Transport (passengers, general transit)
 - **H** — Hauler (cargo, freight, minerals)
 - **I** — Interceptor (law enforcement / paramilitary)
 - **E** — Explorer (survey, science, research)
 - **U** — Unmanned Drone (automated, no hyperdrive)
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Military Roles

Primary mission profile of naval warships.

- **F** — Frigate
 - **D** — Destroyer
 - **C** — Cruiser
 - **B** — Battleship
 - **T** — Troop Transport
 - **H** — Military Hauler / Fleet Supply
 - **R** — Reconnaissance
 - **X** — Titan (supercapital warship)
 - **I** — Interceptor (military)
 - **U** — Unmanned military drone
-

Hyperdrive Grade

Below are all hyperdrive grades used throughout the Aether Galaxy, listed in numerical order with their speed, cost, and usage notes.

Grade 0

- **Speed:** None (system-bound)
 - **Cost:** n/a
 - **Notes:**
 - No hyperdrive installed
 - Used by shuttles, drones, local haulers, survey skiffs
 - Cannot leave the star system
-

Grade 1

- **Speed:** 50 light-years per day
 - **Cost:** Cr25,000
 - **Notes:**
 - Ancient and inefficient
 - Near-extinct; museum or retrofitted vessels
 - Almost never seen in active service
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Grade 2

- **Speed:** 100 light-years per day

- **Cost:** Cr50,000
 - **Notes:**
 - Minimal modern FTL capability
 - Used by budget transports and fringe colonies
 - Slow but serviceable
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Grade 3

- **Speed:** 200 light-years per day
 - **Cost:** Cr100,000
 - **Notes:**
 - Common across civilian fleets
 - Typical for freighters, transports, and passenger ships
 - Reliable and affordable
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Grade 4

- **Speed:** 400 light-years per day
 - **Cost:** Cr200,000
 - **Notes:**
 - Modern civilian standard
 - Used by long-range haulers, mid-tier explorers, and paramilitary
 - Often a best-value choice for corporate fleets
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Grade 5

- **Speed:** 800 light-years per day
 - **Cost:** Cr400,000
 - **Notes:**
 - Express-tier civilian hyperdrives
 - Used by couriers and some military vessels
 - Mark of a high-performance civilian ship
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Grade 6

- **Speed:** 1,600 light-years per day
 - **Cost:** Cr800,000
 - **Notes:**
 - Standard fast military drive
 - Used in recon craft, interceptors, and response ships
 - Balance of speed and reliability for warships
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Grade 7

- **Speed:** 3,200 light-years per day
- **Cost:** Cr1,600,000
- **Notes:**
 - Elite military hyperdrive
 - Restricted; requires high-clearance approval
 - Used by advanced recon vessels and high-command couriers

Grade 8

- **Speed:** 6,400 light-years per day
 - **Cost:** Cr3,200,000
 - **Notes:**
 - Experimental prototype technology
 - Extremely rare; often black-budget or classified
 - Found only in the galaxy's most advanced ships (e.g., WHX-8 Titans)
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Example Structure

- **LT-4** — Light Transport, Grade-4 hyperdrive
 - **LC-2** — Light Courier, Grade-2 hyperdrive
 - **LE-0** — Light Explorer (system-bound)
 - **WLF-5** — Light Frigate, naval, Grade-5 hyperdrive
 - **WMR-5** — Medium Reconnaissance Warship
 - **WHX-5** — Heavy Titan-class Warship
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Zelenor Fleet Industries "Accipiter-class" Light Frigate (WLF-5)

Overview

The **Accipiter-class** WLF-5 is a fast, versatile warship designed for **escort, reconnaissance, and rapid strike missions**. It balances **speed, firepower, and endurance**, making it a staple of the modern Galactic Commonwealth's fleet. Often deployed in **system defense, anti-piracy patrols, and fleet support roles**. The Accipiter-class is also available with a Grade 6 hyperdrive despite its more typical military drive in the original design.

Specifications

Class: Accipiter-class light frigate (WLF-5)

Manufacturer: Zelenor Fleet Industries

Hull Type: Military-grade starcraft

Price: Cr1,200,000 ± Cr150,000 (varies by refit, armament, and hyperdrive condition)

Hyperdrive Grade: 5 (800 light-years/day)

Sublight Performance: High (optimized for rapid intercepts and evasive maneuvers)

Armament:

- **Primary:** Dual heavy blaster turrets (forward-mounted)
- **Secondary:** 4x atomic missile pods (anti-ship/anti-fighter)
- **Defensive:** Point-defense lasers, ECM suite

Cargo Capacity: Light (munitions, spare parts, small cargo)

Troop Capacity: 12 marines or 1 light vehicle

Crew: 10–15 (command, engineering, weapons, support)

Common Users: Galactic Commonwealth, mercenary squadrons, rapid-response fleets

Mission Profile: Escort, reconnaissance, anti-piracy, fleet skirmishing

Interior Layout (Typical Configuration)

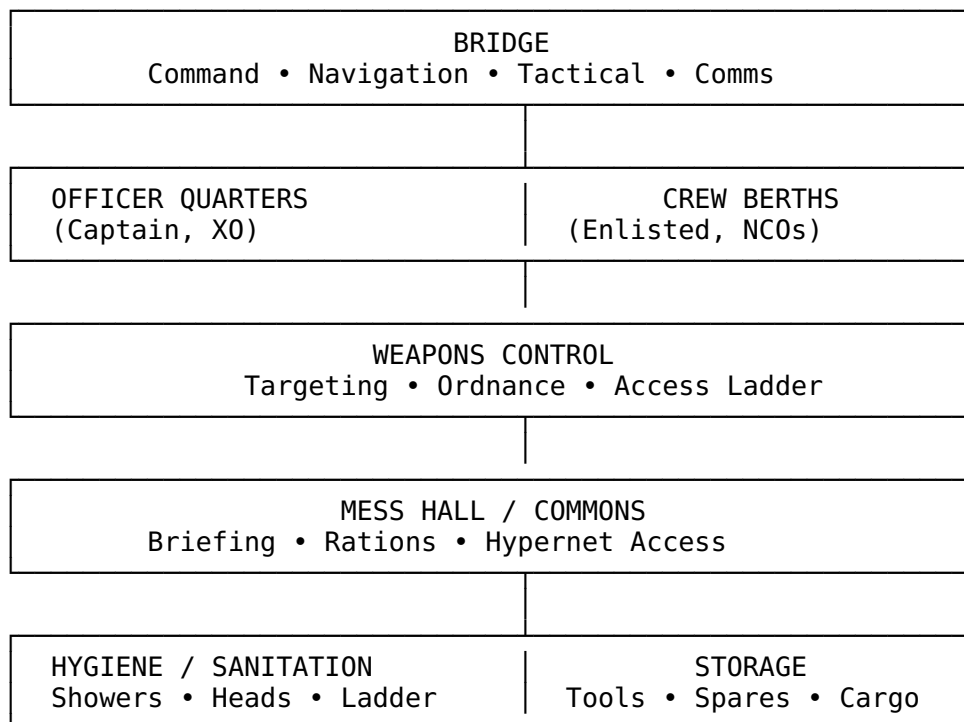
- **Bridge** — Command center, tactical stations
- **Crew Quarters** — Compact bunks for officers/enlisted
- **Armory** — Weapons, armor, and munitions storage
- **Medical Bay** — Emergency trauma unit
- **Engineering** — Hyperdrive, power core, and damage control
- **Weapons Control** — Targeting systems and ordnance management
- **Hangar Bay** — One light vehicle such as an IFV
- **Marine Berths** — Space for a dozen armed marines
- **Common Area** — Briefing space, minimal recreation

Operational Notes

- **Reliability:** Built for sustained combat; requires frequent maintenance after engagements.
 - **Range:** Short-to-medium (optimized for system patrol and rapid deployment).
 - **Crew Workload:** High during combat; skeleton crew possible for transit.
 - **Comfort:** Spartan; prioritizes function over amenities.
 - **Hyperspace Signature:** Aggressive, detectable at long range.
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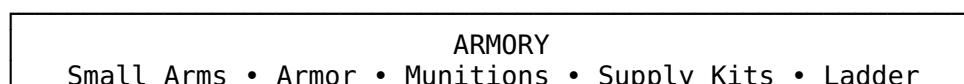
[WLF-5 Accipter-class – Upper Deck]

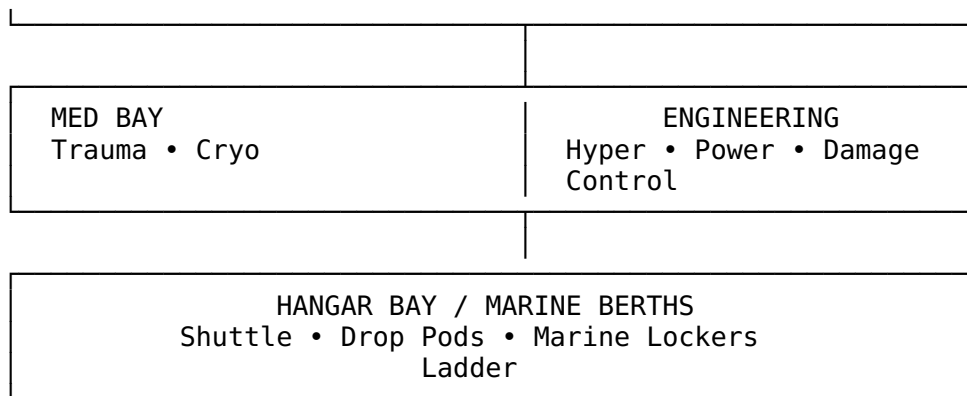
[BOW / FORWARD]



[WLF-5 Accipter-class – Lower Deck]

[BOW / FORWARD]





Werosian Defense Systems "Hellsender-class" Medium Destroyer (WMD-4)

Overview

The Hellsender-class WMD-4 is a purpose-built defensive deterrent designed for independent systems unwilling to surrender sovereignty. Built by Werosian Defense Systems—an arms manufacturer whose entire culture is built on readiness and deterrence—the Hellsender embodies a singular philosophy: make invasion so costly that no aggressor can justify it. She sacrifices mobility and flexibility for overwhelming forward firepower and heavy armor. Slow in transit, terrifyingly quick to rotate. Her way is not so much to chase enemies as to herd them into her broadside. A badger of the spaceship world—compact, fierce, and far more dangerous than her size suggests.

Specifications

Class: Hellsender-class medium destroyer (WMD-4) **Manufacturer:** Werosian Defense Systems **Hull Type:** Military-grade defensive warship **Price:** Cr2,800,000 ± Cr200,000; varies by refit, ordnance loadout, and customization **Hyperdrive Grade:** 4 (400 light-years/day; upgradeable to Grade 5 or 6 with proper refit) **Sublight Performance:** Low, poor acceleration and lateral agility; exceptionally responsive reaction control thrusters for rapid orientation

Armament:

- **Primary:** 8x atomic torpedo launch tubes (forward saturation battery; 0.1c velocity)
- **Secondary:** 1x heavy interceptor pod for point-defense against fighters and fast-movers
- **Tertiary:** 1x customizable hardpoint (customer-configured; often point-defense lasers, ECM suite, or sensor package)

Armor Profile: Heavy forward sections; reinforced amidships around reactor and torpedo magazines; comparatively lighter aft section **Cargo Capacity:** Minimal (ammunition resupply, spare parts, local ordnance production materials) **Troop Capacity:** 35 marines or one medium vehicle **Crew:** 18–24 (command, engineering, weapons systems, damage control, ordnance management) **Common Users:** Independent systems near Iron Dominion or pirate territories; Weros itself maintains a substantial Hellsender fleet **Mission Profile:** System defense, deterrent presence, layered anti-access/area-denial doctrine

Operational Notes

Doctrine: The Hellsender isn't intended to chase. Her low sublight speed is *intentional*—she fights at home, on her terms. Her reaction control thrusters are exceptionally powerful, allowing her to pivot and present her broadside in seconds. The tactic is elegant: appear slow and vulnerable, allow an

aggressor to approach or maneuver, then rotate to face them with 80% of her firepower. Many hostile captains have learned too late that they've been herded into her primary firing arc.

Magazine Warfare: She carries enough atomic torpedoes for sustained defensive engagement but is not designed for long campaigns far from home. Independent systems using Hellsenders pair them with resupply operations and local ordnance production. An aggressor's supply lines are thousands of light-years away. Hers are local.

The Customizable Hardpoint: Werosian Defense Systems provides the ship with one unequipped hardpoint, allowing purchasers to outfit it based on their specific threat environment. This reflects a fundamental design philosophy: "We provide 90% of your defense. You know your threats. Adapt the last 10% to your needs."

Reliability: Built for sustained defensive operations in a single system. Requires heavy maintenance after combat but is designed for quick field repairs using locally-sourced materials.

Crew Workload: Extremely high during combat. The weapon systems and damage control require constant attention. Skeleton crew possible for transit only.

Comfort: Minimal. Spartan quarters, crowded spaces. Crew accommodations are secondary to ammunition storage and engineering.

Hyperspace Signature: Aggressive and detectable at long range.

The Weakness: Without magazines, she loses her primary advantage. A prolonged siege could starve her into irrelevance. She is also sluggish in open-space engagements against fast, maneuverable opponents--which is why independent systems pair her with corvettes and fast interceptors for layered defense.

Interior Layout (Typical Configuration)

Bridge - Command center, navigation, tactical stations

Crew Quarters - Compact bunks for officers and enlisted; minimal privacy

Ordnance Magazine - Primary atomic torpedo storage; heavily shielded and isolated

Reactor Core - Massive power plant; drives rotation thrusters and weapon systems

Weapons Control - Central targeting hub for all torpedo systems; multiple crew stations

Engineering - Hyperdrive, sublight engines, damage control center

Armor Shaping - Specialized plating around magazine and critical systems

Marine Berths - Space for boarding team and security personnel

Auxiliary Magazine - Secondary ordnance storage

Common Area - Briefing space, minimal recreation

Sanitation - Heads and hygiene facilities

Maintenance Lockers - Tools, spares, repair materials

[WMD-4 Hellsender-class – Upper Deck]

[BOW / FORWARD]

TORPEDO LAUNCH ARRAY (Forward Saturation Battery – 8 Tubes) Heavy Bow Armor / Fire Control Integration
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BRIDGE / COMMAND Tactical • Navigation • Targeting • Fleet Comms

WEAPONS CONTROL CENTER
Targeting • Fire Sequencing • Lift • Sensor Fusion

|

OFFICER QUARTERS
Captain • XO • Tactical Staff

|

CREW BERTHS
Weapons Teams • Sensor Ops • Duty Rotation

|

MESS / COMMONS
Briefing • Minimal Recreation • Lift • Rations

|

MAINTENANCE LOCKERS
Tools • Spares • Field Repair Kits

|

INTERCEPTOR POD MOUNT / MARINE BERTHS
Point Defense Craft • Boarding Teams

[WMD-4 Hellsender-class – Lower Deck]

[BOW / FORWARD]

REACTOR CORE / POWER PLANT
Main Output • Rotation Thruster Feed • Weapon Systems

|

ENGINEERING
Hyperdrive • Lift • Sublight Drives

|

PRIMARY ORDNANCE MAGAZINE
Atomic Torpedoes • Heavily Shielded • Blast Isolation

|

AUXILIARY MAGAZINE / ORDNANCE RESERVE
Secondary Torpedoes • Sustained Engagement Stockpile

|

ARMOR SHAPING / STRUCTURAL CORE
Reinforced Bulkheads • Forward Impact Redistribution

|

SANITATION / LIFE SUPPORT Enviro Control • Waste Processing • Lift • Hygiene

Design Philosophy

The Hellsender represents **Werosian pragmatism distilled into steel**: every independent system wants to remain independent. Few can afford true capital ships. The Hellsender exists to make that possible, not through mobility or versatility, but through overwhelming defensive firepower, heavy armor, and the discipline to hold position. She is the answer to imperial aggression from a civilization that believes "peace endures only through readiness."

Paired with corvettes and light frigates in a layered anti-access/area denial doctrine, she transforms her system into a fortress. She may not be beautiful. She may not be graceful. But she is brutally effective at what she was designed to do: make conquest too expensive to justify.

No canon; only coherence.